MEMO

TO	CEO
FROM	Engineering Lead
PERIOD	Next quarter, weeks 1–12 (week 1 starts on approval)
RE	The database, the national broker deal, and next quarter

Bottom line. Next quarter's requests add up to about 28.5 eng-months, including the 4.5 database fix I recommend. We have 22. I'd stop the import outages, win the national broker deal with product instead of a one-off, start SOC 2, and ship a first mobile version so your board statement holds. The commission rework waits a quarter. No database migration and no new hires this quarter.

1 The database: fix it in place and keep MongoDB

WHAT I'D DO Both outages came from one bulk import job on one oversized server, and that job would overload Postgres too. From week 2, imports run on their own queue and servers, one at a time under a database write cap; by week 10 every carrier runs in small, restartable batches. Reports move to a copy of the database. MongoDB has had multi-step transactions since version 4.0, so all multi-step updates go through one shared helper (the useful part of the shared-layer idea) with automated checks.

COST 4.5 eng-months, mostly both Ingestion engineers, plus some AWS spend.

GIVING UP A relational database for now, new carrier integrations until week 10, and the senior Quoting engineer's preferred plan. They'll own the transaction work and the criteria for revisiting Postgres.

CHANGE MY MIND If the database still struggles with imports isolated, we tune and resize MongoDB first. If integrity bugs persist in flows on the helper, or finance needs queries our data model can't serve, we move that one area to Postgres.

2 The national broker: yes, re-scoped before we sign

WHAT I'D DO The contract is unsigned and their rollout is about five months out (week 21), so we can reshape it. State-specific quoting rules become a standard feature by week 8; two prospects want them too. The export becomes a configurable feature from week 10, built by Billing so Carrier Ingestion stays on the outages. Instead of a separate database we offer enforced data separation, access logs, encryption and SOC 2. A separate database, if still required, becomes a priced tier, quoted before signing and built before rollout.

COST 4.0 eng-months, the size of the original ask, spent on product we can sell again.

GIVING UP The export misses the 8-week promise by two weeks, Sales walks back part of a yes, and the customer may walk (8% of revenue).

CHANGE MY MIND If they need it before rollout, Platform and the senior Quoting engineer build it this quarter from the reserve, and SOC 2 slips about three weeks.

GOING FORWARD Sales gets engineering sign-off within 24 hours before promising scope or dates. Customer settings, including our two existing one-offs, get tests on every release.

3 Next quarter: 20.0 committed, 2.0 in reserve

WHAT I'D DO Stability 4.5, national broker 4.0, SOC 2 3.0, mobile 5.5, support tooling 1.5, commission safety checks 1.0, AI for every engineer 0.5, reserve 2.0. Mobile version 1 covers what brokers do away from their desk (find a policy, share documents, get quote and bind alerts) and is in the app

stores by week 12. I'd suggest telling the board now that "ships" means the first version, not the full release. SOC 2 Type 2 needs at least three months of audited evidence, so controls go live by week 8 to start the clock. A hire costs half an engineer for three months, so the platform role opens now and the integrations role waits for week 6's AI results.

COST All 22 eng-months, plus outside spend on SOC 2 and AI tools (see appendix).

GIVING UP Most of the commission rework (5 down to 1, so the CFO loses most), the full mobile app (9 to 5.5), half of support tooling, and new web-app features.

CHANGE MY MIND If commission errors are costing money or customers today (I'm checking payout adjustments this week), the reserve goes to commissions first. If week 1's mobile prototype puts week 12 at risk, we start with a few brokers and tell the board in week 2.

On AI. I'm investing, not betting: agents for every engineer under written SOC 2 rules, AI first reviews on every code change and an AI support assistant, for about $5–10k a month. Dates assume no speed-up; measured time saved goes to support tooling, then quoting on mobile. AI never has the last word on money, binding or compliance.